25900681 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025

Third SEMESTER

MG3VACVCN200 – ADVERTISEMENT AND SOCIETY

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 Hour 30 Minutes **Maximum Marks: 50**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyze (An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation (Ap)

Answer Key

Part A – Short Answer (Any 5 × 2 = 10 Marks)

Q.No.	Question	Key Points	Marks
1	What is a scarcity tactic in advertising?	Creating artificial urgency to increase demand – e.g., "Limited stock", "Offer ends today". Psychological trigger of FOMO (Fear of Missing Out).	2
2	What is "objectification" of women in ads?	Depicting women as physical or sexual objects; focusing on appearance or body parts to sell products; denies individuality and personality.	2
3	Name one global case where lack of ethics in advertising caused backlash.	*Example:* Pepsi 2017 Kendall Jenner ad trivializing social movements / H&M "Coolest Monkey" hoodie ad.	2
4	Recall one consequence of unethical advertising.	Loss of consumer trust, public backlash, legal action, or brand reputation damage.	2

Q.No.	Question	Key Points	Marks
5	State one challenge regulatory bodies face with digital advertising.	Difficulty tracking influencer marketing, sponsored content, cross-border ads, and misinformation.	2
6	What is greenwashing?	Misleading consumers by falsely claiming environmental benefits (e.g., “eco-friendly” without proof).	2
7	Define consumer motivation.	Internal psychological drive that prompts consumers to make purchase decisions based on needs and desires.	2

Part B – Paragraph Answers (Any 4 × 5 = 20 Marks)

Q.No.	Question	Key Points	Marks
8	Describe the role of Instagram in brand building.	Visual storytelling, influencer marketing, audience engagement through reels/stories, brand aesthetics, community creation, and real-time interaction.	5
9	Apply the fairness cream ads controversy to ethical responsibility.	Promotes colorism and bias; unethical portrayal of fairness as success; ethical advertising should promote diversity and confidence. Example: “Dark is Beautiful” campaign.	5
10	Explain how ads influence family values.	Reshape aspirations, promote materialism, redefine gender roles, create consumerist family ideals, and impact lifestyle choices.	5
11	Write a note on the scope of advertising in the digital age.	Data-driven marketing, AI tools, global reach, personalization, influencer campaigns, interactive storytelling, and measurable impact.	5
12	Apply strategies of responsible advertising to gender representation.	Avoid gender stereotypes; show balanced portrayals; promote empowerment. Example:	5

Q.No.	Question	Key Points	Marks
		Ariel's "Share the Load" or Dove's Real Beauty campaign.	
13	How did TV transform consumer culture through advertisements?	Introduced mass media culture, celebrity endorsements, aspirational living, shared cultural narratives, and stronger brand loyalty.	5

Part C – Essay (Any 2 × 10 = 20 Marks)

Q.No.	Question	Key Points	Marks
14	Discuss the significance of storytelling in digital advertising platforms.	Storytelling enhances emotional connection, authenticity, and recall. Involves relatable characters, conflict, and resolution. Examples: Google "Reunion", Nike "You Can't Stop Us". Builds trust and brand loyalty.	10
15	Discuss harmful effects of racial and cultural stereotypes with examples.	Reinforces prejudice, social inequality, and exclusion. Examples: Dove "White is Purity" ad, fairness creams. Ethical advertising promotes inclusivity and respect for diversity.	10
16	Discuss the impact of advertising bans on alcohol in different cultures.	Reduces public exposure; encourages surrogate ads (e.g., soda/club events). Varies culturally — total bans in Islamic countries, restricted in India, liberal in Europe. Ethical need to protect youth.	10
17	Discuss the societal functions of advertising with reference to globalization.	Promotes economic growth, cultural exchange, and consumer identity. Acts as a social mirror and educator. Spreads global trends and ideals of modernity.	10
